

You pay twice to charge a car here, and nothing shows you both

By Dr Aakash Chavan Ravindranath

Charging an electric car in the Netherlands involves two separate payments, and most of us only ever think about one of them.

The electricity goes through your charge card. You hold the card against the post, the kWh are metered, and that bill comes from whoever issued the card. Straightforward enough.

The parking is the other one. A charging bay inside a paid parking zone is still a paid parking space. The street tariff runs for the whole time you are plugged in, you pay it through a completely different app or meter, and nothing at the charge point mentions it.

Two bills, two companies, no connection between them. Which means when you are deciding where to go, you can see one number and not the other.

What I was actually trying to do

I wanted to find a cheap charger with cheap parking. That is the entire question, and I could not find anywhere that answers it.

There are plenty of apps that show charger prices. There are plenty that handle parking. I could not find one that puts them together, which seems odd, because the two costs are completely entangled and you cannot avoid either.

So I went and got the data instead. The national charge point register has every public post in the country. The national parking register has the tariffs. Both are public. As far as I could tell nobody had joined them, so I did.

What the join shows

Take an ordinary stop. Twenty kWh over two hours, a top-up while you do something else rather than a full charge.

The electricity comes to €8.20 at the national median of €0.41 per kWh, and that figure barely moves around the country. The parking is what changes.

CITY	PARKING, 2 HRS	TOTAL	PARKING'S SHARE
Delft	€7.28	€15.48	47%
Utrecht	€7.16	€15.36	47%
Haarlem	€6.98	€15.18	46%
The Hague	€6.40	€14.60	44%
Amsterdam	€6.00	€14.20	42%
Nijmegen	€5.80	€14.00	41%

CITY	PARKING, 2 HRS	TOTAL	PARKING'S SHARE
Zwolle	€5.46	€13.66	40%
Groningen	€4.50	€12.70	35%
Maastricht	€4.34	€12.54	35%
Rotterdam	€4.00	€12.20	33%
Breda	€4.00	€12.20	33%
Tilburg	€4.00	€12.20	33%
Leiden	€3.80	€12.00	32%
Eindhoven	€3.00	€11.20	27%

In Delft and Utrecht nearly half of what a charging stop costs you is not electricity. Across these fourteen cities the average is 38%.

At least 12,667 Dutch charge points sit inside a paid parking area. Nobody is doing anything underhand. It is two systems that were built separately and have no particular reason to talk to each other.

The variables you cannot see

The electricity is not one price either. The median is €0.41 per kWh, but most posts land somewhere between €0.28 and €0.63. Same grid, same electricity. The variable is whose logo is on the post. Vattenfall InCharge averages €0.32, E-Flux by Road averages €0.51.

Then there is the card. Each charge card negotiates its own rate with each operator, so the cheapest card is a different card at different posts. At one socket the gap between the best and worst card commonly runs 40 to 70 percent.

Operator, card, parking. Three things moving at once, none of which you can compare while standing on a pavement.

What I built

Every public charge point in the country, what the electricity costs there, and the parking tariff for the ground underneath it, added together for however long you actually intend to stay.

It is free, there is no sign-up and no app, and I am not selling anything. I mention that because it is a fair thing to wonder about.

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Even if you never use it, the habit worth having is checking whether the bay sits in a paid zone before you plug in. It takes seconds and it is the largest avoidable cost here. Driving to a cheaper city saves you very little, the gap between two posts on the same street can be much bigger.

Charging data: the national charge point register via NDW and DOT-NL. Parking tariffs: the national parking register, 323 register-listed garages across 14 cities, snapshot 30 September 2026. Both datasets are published openly on the site. The figures above use median tariffs, so an individual stop will differ; if you find an error in the arithmetic I would like to hear about it.